JENNY SIQIN DING

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PLACEMENT DIRECTORS

Prof. Luminita Stevens	stevens7@umd.edu	(301) 405-3515
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EDUCATION

Ph.D.	Economics, University of Maryland at College Park, expected May 2027
B.S.	Mathematics and Economics, University of Wisconsin-Madison, May 2020

FIELDS OF SPECIALIZATION

Primary:	Macroeconomics
Secondary:	Macro Labor, International Trade, International Finance

DISSERTATION

Essays on Wage Dynamics and Aggregate Labor Market Frictions
Committee: Prof. John Haltiwanger (Co-chair), Prof. Luminita Stevens (Co-chair), Prof. Thomas Dreschel

JOB MARKET PAPER

"The Value of Lucky Hires: Match Quality Innovations and Firm Dynamics"

Match quality plays a central role in search-and-matching models of job creation, job destruction, and worker turnover, yet it is difficult to measure directly. This paper develops a new measure of match quality from a matched worker-employer panel built from LinkedIn profiles compiled by Revelio Labs (2007–2025). A Hidden Markov Model classifies employment spells into latent match states based on spell duration, transition outcome, and the worker's employment history. For each spell, the match innovation measures the deviation of the realized match-state distribution from its predicted distribution based on information available at the time of match formation. These innovations provide an empirical analogue of unexpected match quality and are aggregated to the firm level to examine their relationship with subsequent firm outcomes. Among Compustat firms, conditional on firm controls, a 10-percentage-point shift in match innovations from "churning" matches prone to separation toward internal growth tracks predicts 3.9 percentage points higher employment growth, a 1.5-percentage-point higher probability of survival, and 4.8 percent higher sales. These magnitudes are comparable to prior estimates of a one-standard-deviation increase in TFP across U.S. manufacturing establishments, suggesting that match quality is an important component of the firm-level heterogeneity underlying employment growth and survival.

OTHER RESEARCH PAPERS

"Inaccurate Beliefs and Cyclical Labor Market Dynamics," *under review at AEJ:Macroeconomics*

This paper examines how systematic biases and heterogeneity in beliefs about the state of the economy shape labor market dynamics. I present evidence that households form dispersed, sluggish expectations, with more optimistic workers demanding higher wages. I develop a search-and-matching model with sticky wages and endogenous separations where workers and firms face information frictions about aggregate productivity. The gap between firm and worker beliefs drives unemployment volatility, while delayed firm learning raises persistence. Heterogeneity in workers' learning rates explains observed differences in employment transitions: workers with more sluggish beliefs are hired at higher wages and face greater separation risk in downturns.

"Capital–Skill Complementarity, Consumption Upgrading, and the Rising Skill Premium," *under review at Review of Economic Dynamics*

Using household expenditure data and a new occupation-based measure of skill intensity, I document two facts. First, higher-income households allocate a larger share of their spending to skill-intensive goods and services, suggesting that income growth can raise the skill premium through demand. Second, holding real income fixed, consumption has shifted toward these goods and services over time, pointing to additional roles for technological change and relative prices. To quantify the sources of the rise in the U.S. skill premium, I develop a model that combines capital–skill complementarity, final-good-specific production technologies, and nonhomothetic preferences. I provide new estimates of capital–skill complementarity at the final-good level, showing that equipment complements high-skill labor and substitutes for low-skill labor. Equipment accumulation accounts for 83.5% of the predicted rise in the skill premium, and productivity-driven consumption upgrading for 8.4%.

"Hiring under Pressure: Financial Constraints and Match Quality," *with Xincheng Qiu, in progress*

This paper examines how financial constraints shape firms' recruitment decisions and labor market outcomes. Using firm-level data on job postings and financial characteristics, we document that firms with higher debt-to-asset ratios exhibit shorter vacancy durations. We propose a mechanism in which financial constraints induce firms to lower their hiring standards, resulting in faster recruitment but lower match quality. To formalize this mechanism, we develop a search-and-matching model with heterogeneous firms subject to financial frictions. Holding hiring standards fixed, tighter financial constraints make vacancies more difficult to fill by limiting firms' ability to finance recruitment expenditures. However, when financial constraints bind, firms place a higher cost on continued search and optimally lower their hiring standards. This endogenous selection response can shorten vacancy durations, but at the expense of lower average match quality and higher subsequent separation rates. We use the model to investigate how policies that relax firms' credit constraints affect hiring decisions, match quality, and aggregate productivity in the long run.

RESEARCH AND RELEVANT WORK EXPERIENCE

Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis Summer Dissertation Fellowship, 2025
Research Assistant, Prof. Catherine Thomas, London School of Economics, Summer 2019
Research Intern, China Development Bank, Summer 2018

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor (University of Maryland)
- Intermediate Macroeconomic Analysis (BS), Summer 2023
- Intermediate Macroeconomics (BA), Summer 2022, Summer 2024

Teaching Assistant (University of Maryland)

Intermediate Macroeconomic Analysis (BS), Spring 2023
Intermediate Macroeconomics (BA), Spring 2022, Fall 2022, Spring 2024, Fall 2024
Globalization and the Capital Market, Fall 2023, Fall 2024
Principles of Macroeconomics, Fall 2020, Spring 2021, Fall, 2021, Fall 2026

Teaching Assistant (University of Wisconsin)
Money and Banking, Fall 2019, Spring 2020

GRANTS AND AWARDS

Roger and Alicia Betancourt Dissertation Fellowship in Applied Economics, 2025
Dean's Research Initiative, University of Maryland, 2025
1st Summer School by the Journal of International Economics, University of Crete, 2023
Study Abroad Scholar Grant, University of Wisconsin-Madison, 2018-2019
Dean's List, University of Wisconsin-Madison, 2017-2020

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2025-2026: SED (Athens), St. Louis Fed, Lisbon Macro Workshop, Midwest Macro (Cleveland Fed), Econometric Society European Winter Meeting (Cyprus), Econometric Society Asia Meeting (Hong Kong), Eleventh Conference of the Society for the Study of Economic Inequality
2023-2024: Stanford SITE (The Micro and Macro of the Labor Market), Federal Reserve Board, LACEA-LAMES (Montevideo), DMV Macro PhD Symposium

COMPUTATIONAL SKILLS

Python, R, Matlab, Stata, EViews

REFERENCES

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